

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, April 8, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Manager Bates removed Item I Resolution 2026-47 additional audit funding from the agenda.

Mayor Girard removed Item E and F, the union collective bargaining agreements from the agenda.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the of March 13, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept the minutes of the of March 17, 2026, City Council meeting.

Councilor O’Hearne suggested making a correction for the date of the meeting to be Tuesday not Wednesday, both Assistant Mayor Matteau and Councilor Greenrose agreed.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – abstain
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstained

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Irish to accept the minutes of the of March 25, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard read a proclamation for Library Director Mike Grace's retirement.

Tomorrow evening the Claremont Maker Space will be hosting a small business round table from 5p-7p.

The Well Collaborative will host an annual May-Day breakfast on Saturday May 2nd from 8am-11am at the First Congressional Church on Pleasant Street.

Parks and Recreation are working on their annual CSBCCC scholarship golf tournament on May 20th.

Turning Points Network will be hosting A Steppin' Up to Violence 5K walk and run Saturday May 2nd.

Youth soccer registration is open until May 14th.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Bates noted there will be an Open House for Mike Grace at the Fiske Free Library on Tuesday April 14, 2026, at 1pm in honor of his retirement.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Conservation Commission

A motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Erin Graf-Greenrose to seat A-2 to the Conservation Commission.

Councilor Greenrose recused himself.

Voice vote:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – recused

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Hemingway – abstained
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstained

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to re-appoint Gary Dickerman to seat A-2 on the Conservation Commission.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Planning Board

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to re-appoint Bruce Kolenda to Seat 5 of the Claremont Planning Board.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to re-appoint Maxime J. Guinel to Seat 6 of the Claremont Planning Board.

Voice vote:

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

HDC

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to re-appoint Jill Chastenay to Seat 3 of the HDC.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Zoning Board

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to re-appoint Wayne Hemingway to Seat 4 of the ZBA.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Irish and seconded by Councilor Cogswell to re-appoint Mike Lemuix to Seat 5 of the ZBA.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Councilor Hemingway would like to receive attendance records for committee appointments.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Assistant Mayor Matteau gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Earnest Montenegro, Ward 1, shared a portrait he created of former City Manager, Guy Santagate and would like Council to accept it and hang it in the Council Chambers.

Charlene Lovett, Ward II, shared the upcoming community wide Clean-up event hosted by Claremont Sugar River Rotary Club.

NEW BUSINESS

FY26 Fee Schedule Adjustment – Public Hearing

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Manager Bates introduced the fiscal year 2026 fee schedule adjustment. This would take effect for this fiscal year and includes lane rentals and bulk water sales.

Director Martin explained the lane rental fees and then the removal of Arrowhead fees as these fees are outlined and clearly defined in an agreement.

Director Gleeson explained the update for the bulk water sales.

Mayor Girard mentioned that Lebanon sells their water at \$100, and wants to stay competitive. Councilor Koloski agrees and would be happy to move forward but agrees with the \$100 fee.

Assistant Mayor Matteau and Councilor Greenrose agree.

By consensus the Bulk water fee will change from \$150 to \$100.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Irish to accept the FY26 Fee.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

FY27 Fee Schedule – Public Hearing

Manager Bates recommend the health code fees be postponed until the City hires a health officer who could accurately speak to these changes.

By Consensus council agrees to not move forward with health code changes at this time.

Chief Wilmot explained the changes to the fee schedule were in line with 91-A. Communication 911 only had changes to the false alarm billing, this portion was not in the packet. By consensus

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Council has agreed to add the Communication 911 changes to the fee schedule.

A motion was made by Councilor Irish and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept FY27 Fee schedule with the addition of Communications 911.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-39 North and Main Additional Funding - Public Hearing

Manager Bates introduced project engineer from McFarland Johnson, Brian Colburn to give an update on the North and Main project, and noted the need for additional funding to complete the road construction part of the project.

Manager Bates is suggesting to use Fund Balance. Councilor Hemingway shared concerns with using Fund Balance and would like the City to find money elsewhere. There was a suggestion to use Funds From DPW. Manager Bates noted this isn’t a DPW project, it was a Planning and Development project that DPW has been helping to manage due to the lack of staff in the Planning Department.

Councilor Koloski asked what holding off does to the timeline, Manager Bates explained the change orders can’t be signed without approved funding.

RESOLUTION 2026-39

North and Main Street Additional Funding

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

WHEREAS the City would like to continue and complete the North and Main DOT Highway Project to the plan specifications; and

WHEREAS an additional amount of \$59,400 is needed to cover the City's twenty percent (20%) share of the total new change order for \$297,000.00, the remaining \$237,600 to be paid by the state;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the City Council hereby raises and appropriates the sum of Fifty-Nine Thousand Four Hundred Dollars (\$59,400) from the Unassigned General Fund Balance to complete the North and Main Street DOT Highway Project; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his/her designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 8th day of April, 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2026-29.

Councilor Koloski read Resolution 2026-39 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – no

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – no

Hemingway – no

Irish – yes

Girard – no

Motion carried failed 5-4

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Director Gleeson explained The City of Claremont has been selected to receive 100% grant-funded design, engineering, and permitting preparation services for a proposed GSI project at the Park Avenue site. This project will evaluate and develop stormwater management solutions, such as stormwater planters, which are intended to reduce runoff, improve water quality, and provide additional community and environmental benefits. City Planner, Ford added the goal is to reduce nitrogen pollution.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2026-42.

Councilor O’Hearne read Resolution 2026-42 into the record.

Councilor Koloski asked Mr. Ford how many sites were submitted from Claremont, Mr. Ford replied 6 sites. Councilor Koloski then asked why this particular site was chosen. City Planner Ford suspects the slope.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-45 Lease/Purchase Agreement for Fire Apparatus – Public Hearing

Fire Chief Chamberlain is seeking Council approval for the funding of a new fire engine/apparatus. Discussions began over a year ago where needs were identified, and formed an apparatus committee, then met with several manufacturers. From there the Committee created an RFP that closely models the current engine (Engine 3), four separate bids were received. Desorcie Manufacturing was the lowest bidder, but the department currently operates three other E-1 apparatuses. Chief Chamberlain and Treasurer Parks have been working closely together for funding options. Treasurer Parks then presented all three funding options.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Mayor Girard noted the Council isn't interested in leasing until the City has the product and would rather see the money in Capital Reserve and putting it away so the City would have to borrow less later on. Mayor Girard then referenced the CIP and not seeing these projects in it and for those reasons Mayor Girard can't support any of the options.

Councilor Cogswell noted the average delivery of these trucks is three years and prices of them rise by about 5% a year. If its ordered today it could save taxpayers later on or hope prices come down, Councilor Cogswell supports option 3.

Councilor Greenrose stated not wanting to kick a payment down the road but noted this seems to be the way these types of purchases are.

Councilor Irish is also in favor of option 3.

Treasurer Parks initial recommendation was option 1, after discussion she has suggested taking option 1 and amending it.

Council agreed on the amendment to add "with funding mechanisms to be determined at a future date".

Councilor Hemingway clarified this wouldn't prevent the City from putting money aside, Treasurer Parks confirmed.

RESOLUTION 2026-45

Fire Apparatus Lease Authorization to Purchase/Lease

WHEREAS an engine apparatus in the Claremont Fire Department is scheduled for replacement, with a contract to build to be executed in FY2026; and

WHEREAS the City is prepared to replace said apparatus;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after public hearing duly noticed, that it authorizes the purchase/lease of said apparatus for a total principal cost of \$948,364.00 **with a funding mechanism to be determined at a future date;** and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the proposed lease agreement shall contain a non-appropriation clause; and

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. (2/3 vote required)

Dated this 8th day of April 2026 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept resolution 2026-45 Option 1. With amendment to add: “with a funding mechanism to be determined at a future date”.

Assistant Mayor Matteau read Resolution 2026-45 option 1 with amendment into the record.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-46 CRDC Asbestos Mitigation Grant 56 Opera House Square– Public Hearing

Manager Bates noted Asbestos was found during roof work at 56 Opera House Square, and the current grant cannot cover the \$29,740 needed to remove it. A separate CRDC Brownfields grant of \$31,740, with no match required, has been identified to fund the abatement. Manager Bates is requesting Council approval to accept and use these funds so the project can be completed.

RESOLUTION 2026-46

Capital Regional Development Council Brownfields Program – 56 Opera House Square

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont has received notice that it has been awarded a Brownfield Program Sub-Grant (the "Grant") from Capital Regional Development Council (the "Grantor") in

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

the amount of \$31,740.00 with no match requirement for asbestos abatement at 56 Opera House Square; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend these funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept and expend the specified funds and to implement the funded project in an amount not to exceed \$31,740.00. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 8th day of April 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to Resolution 2026-46.

Councilor Greenrose read Resolution 2026-46 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Website Discussion

Manager Bates explained the City’s current website provider has been operating without a formal contract since 2020 and has caused ongoing issues with functionality and responsiveness and emphasized the importance of a reliable website and will begin work on developing a new site and selecting a new provider, with costs to be included in the FY2027 budget. Council input was requested, including whether to form a committee, with a goal of launching a new website by January 2027.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Councilor Cogswell was surprised that the City's website is run by a single individual and stated this is important to the community and excited to see this move forward then asked if it will go through an RFP.

Manager Bates replied it would but needs a scope developed.

Councilor Irish also didn't realize it was only one person. Councilor Limoges stated he has trouble with the current mobile view.

Councilor Koloski doesn't think its necessary to establish a committee and stated he trusts the Manager's judgment.

By consensus Council agrees to move forward with process.

Main Street Strategy Development Project Discussion

Manager Bates explained that the former Planning and Development Director had received a \$50,000 grant for business round table and business labs, and the downtown strategy development. These items were for Phase I of the grant, and the majority of the funds were used on the round tables/labs. The Main Street Strategy Development Project was put out to bid and awarded but does not have enough funding to finish and to stay in compliance. the Claremont Development Authority (CDA), applied for a Phase II in the amount of \$465,460 through the Office of Senator Jeanne Shaheen. The Phase II grant work would expand on the work done by the Phase I grant and would create a co-working space to support small businesses in Claremont.

After discussion Council agrees by consensus to have Manager Bates bring back options for funding.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Cogswell reported the Conservation Commission discussed a letter of support for beautification of Broad Street Park such as tree plantings.

Councilor Koloski reported that the Arts Committee has ongoing fundraising the for the Eagle Restoration and will soon have information coming forward about the Our Town Grant.

Councilor Limoges reported the CDA had discussed the asbestos at 56 Opera House Square, the vacancy at 3 Tremont and the possibility of an RFP for a realtor, and billing relative to the Claremont Creative Center bathroom cleaning.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

Councilor Hemingway reported the Zoning Board of Adjustments discussed a variance for a manufactured home and was ultimately denied.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Irish would like to see the Santagate Portrait hung where the former Manager used to sit in Council Chambers.

Councilor Koloski shared concerns about the lighting of the soldier in the park and the flag pole itself and purchased four replacement lights and is donating them to the City.

Councilor O’Hearne would like to accept the portrait.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:40 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to adjourn.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council